

Inha University in Tashkent

***Theme 10.* The Philosophy of Society. “Uzbek model” of Development**

Tashkent – 2024

Outline:



The Concept of
Society



Historical Evolution
of the Theory



Elements of Social
Structure

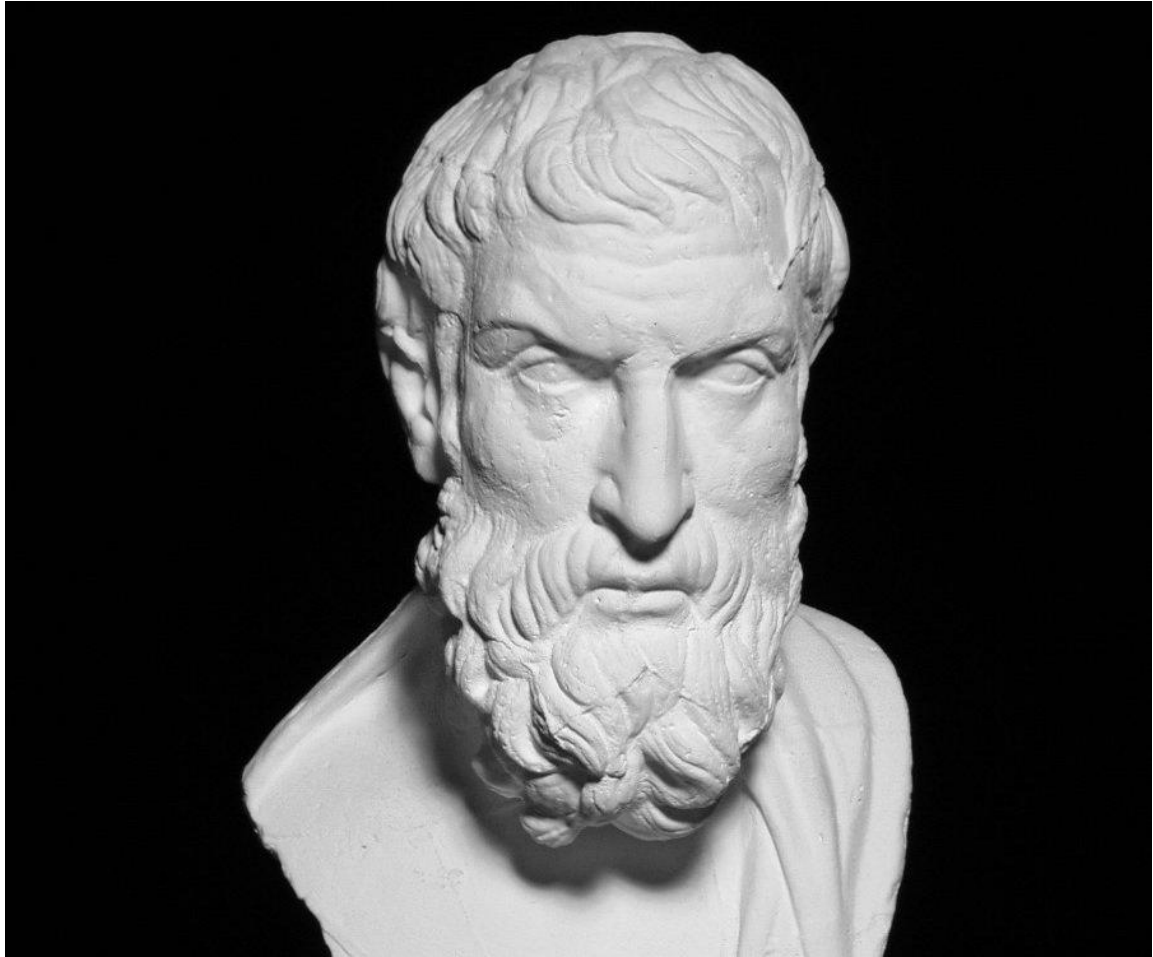


“Uzbek model” of
Development

What is a society?

- Society is a form of association of people with common interests, values and goals.
- Representatives of different areas of social philosophy define the concept of society as a specific social system ("social organism").
- Considering society as a system of human interactions, they diverge in understanding the basics of the concept.
- Some scholars take as the basis of the society the spiritual principles of people's activity and behavior (consciousness, spiritual needs, spiritual values, etc.), others consider the material needs and material conditions of social life as a basis.



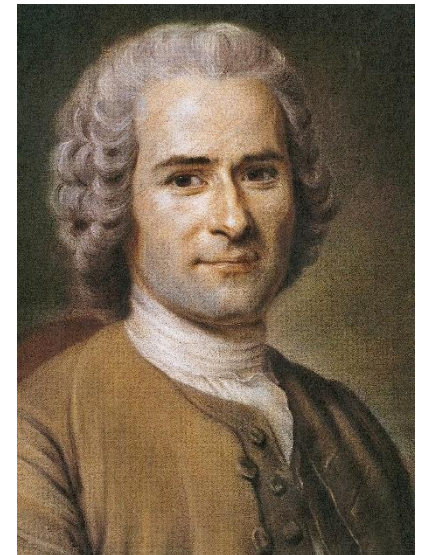
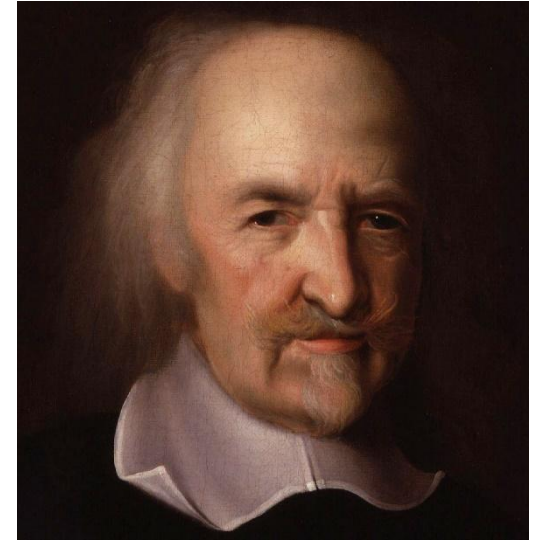


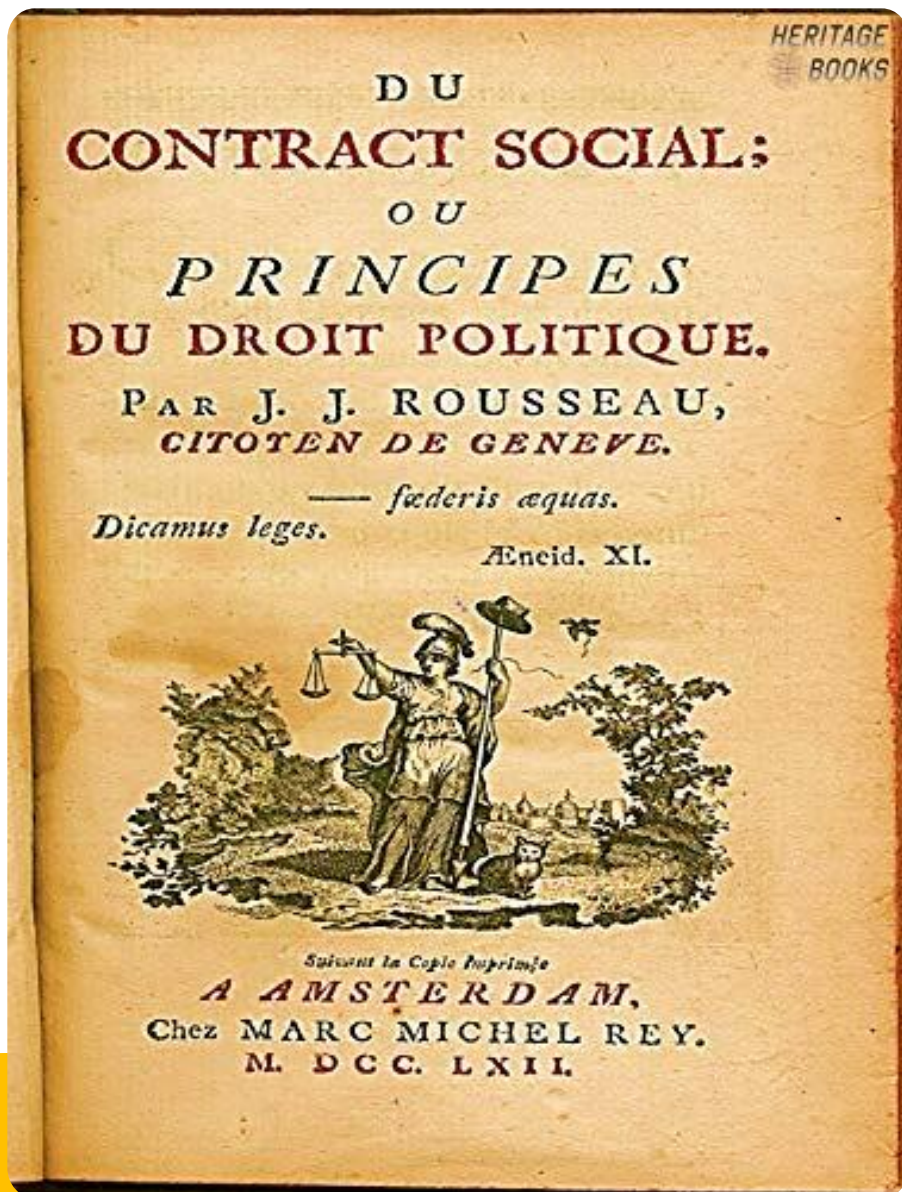
The Historical Development of the Concept

- Many scientists tried to explore society, determine its nature, essence
- The ancient Greek philosopher and scholar Aristotle understood society as a totality of individuals who united to satisfy their social instincts
- Social Instinct - desire for contact and a feeling of belonging in a social setting
- Epicurus believed that the main thing in society is social justice as a result of a contract between people about not harming each other and not suffering harm.

The Concept in Medieval and Modern Periods

- According to the religious approach, the society is formed by the will of God.
- In the West European social science of the 17th and 18th centuries, the scholars such as Thomas Hobbes (1588-1679) and Jean-Jacques Rousseau opposed to religious dogma, put forward the idea of a social contract, that is, a treaty between people, where each of them has sovereign rights to control their actions.
- This idea was opposed to a theological approach to the organization of society.



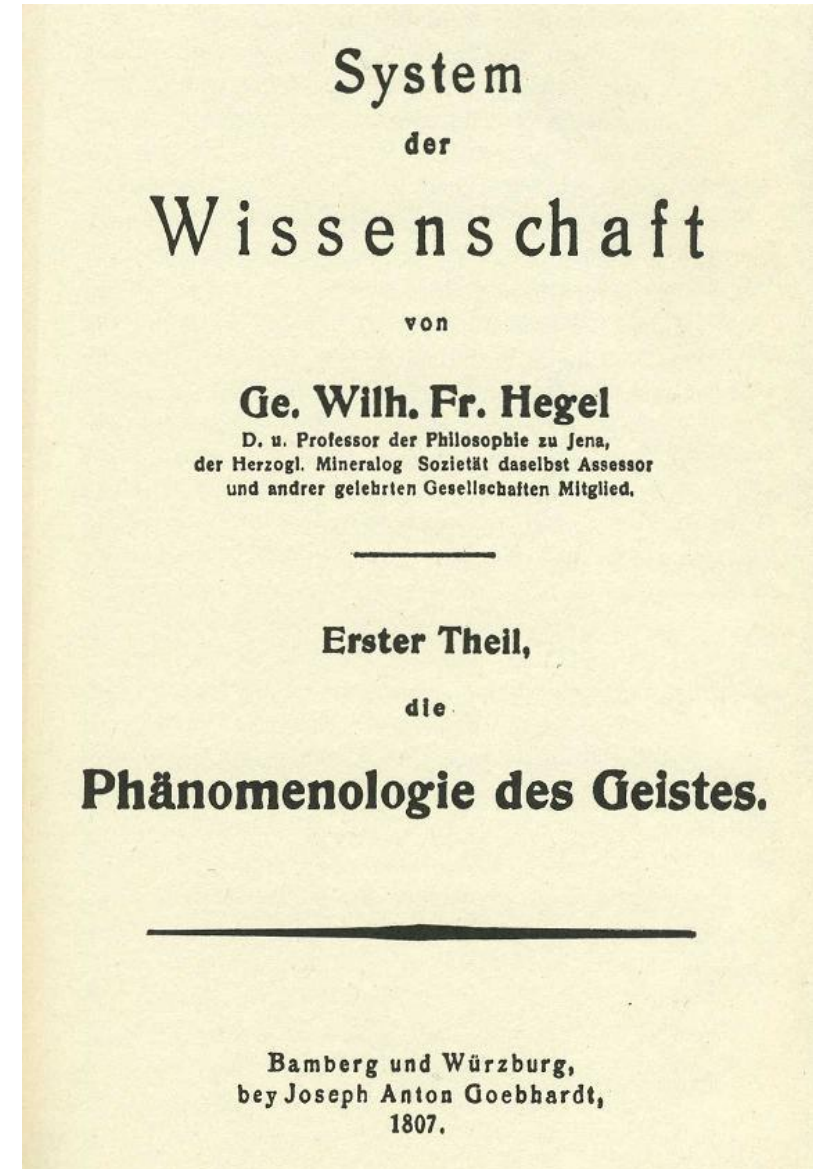


Jean-Jacques Rousseau

- He was engaged in political philosophy
- Thomas Hobbes put forward the idea of a social contract in his book "Leviathan" (1651)
- John Locks's "Two Treatises of Government" (1689) holds a human's natural right to defend "life, health, liberty or possessions".
- Like them, Rousseau compared an idea of humanity in a hypothetical "natural state" with how people actually live in a civil society.
- According to Rousseau:
 - Man in a 'state of nature is fundemantally good;
 - When the idea of private property developed, society had to develop a system to protect it;
- This system evolved as laws imposed by those with property onto those without property;
- These laws bind people in unjust ways;
- So, man is born free, yet everywhere he is in chains.

Georg Hegel

- Hegel was the single most famous philosopher in Germany during the first half of the 19th century.
- His central idea was that all phenomena, from consciousness to political institutions, are aspects of a single Spirit (by which he means “mind” or “idea”) that over the course of time is reintegrating these aspects into itself.
- This process of reintegration is what Hegel calls the “dialectic”, and it is one that we (who are all aspects of Spirit) understand as “history.”
- Hegel tried to view society as a complex system of relations, singling out as a subject of consideration so-called civil society, that is, a society where everyone depends on everyone.

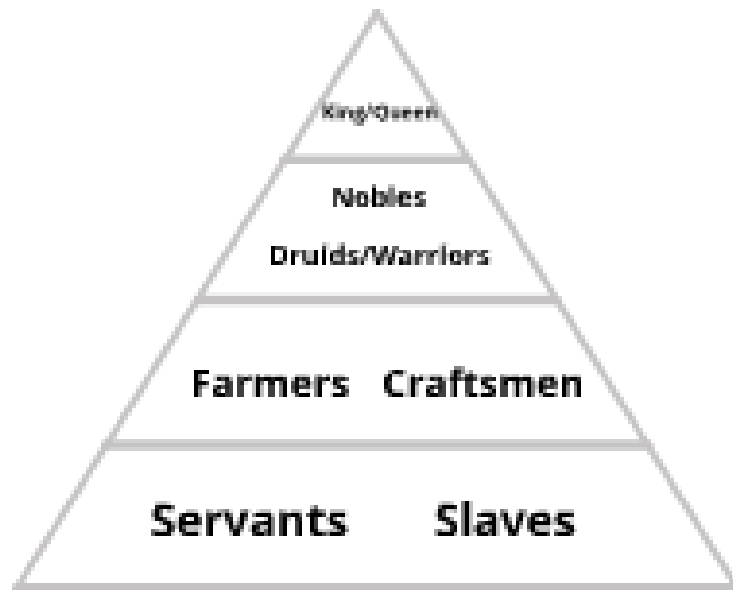


The Historical Development of the Concept

- Of great importance for the scientific understanding of society were the works of one of the founders of scientific sociology, Auguste Comte (1798-1857)
- He is the author of famous work – “The Course in Positive Philosophy”
- Auguste Comte regarded society as a system of elements by which the family, classes and state act, and the basis is the division of labor between people and their mutual relations
- A similar definition of society is found in Western European sociology of the 20th century. So, for Max Weber, society is a product of people's interaction as a result of their social actions in the interests of everyone



The main elements of the social structure of society



- The main elements of the social structure of society are:
 - ✓ classes;
 - ✓ people of the city and village;
 - ✓ representatives of physical and mental labor;
 - ✓ socio-demographic groups - youth, women, men, the older generation of people;
 - ✓ national communities - nations, ethnic groups, etc.

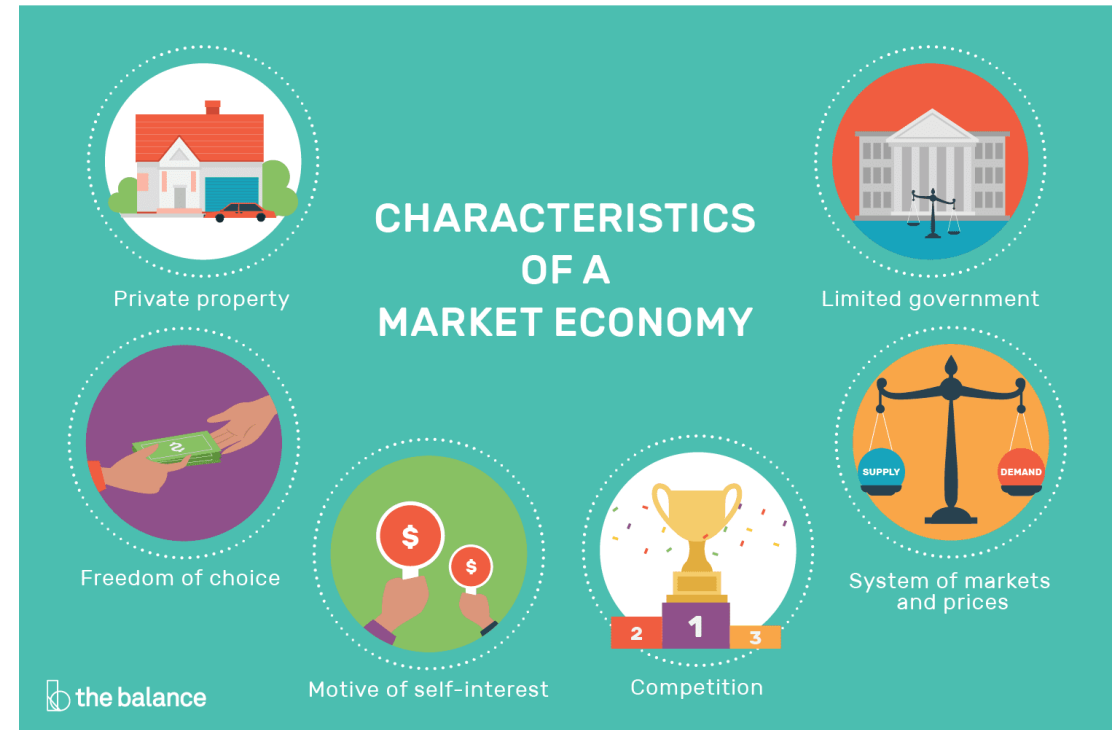
The Uzbek Model of Development

- The First President of Uzbekistan Islam Karimov in his book "Uzbekistan - own model of transition to market relations" developed the "Uzbek model", based on five principles of economic reform and democratic development of society:
 - 1) De-ideologization of the economy.
 - 2) The state is the main reformer.
 - 3) The supremacy of law.
 - 4) The strong social policy.
 - 5) The transition to market economy step-by-step.



The First Principle

- The leading principle of building a new society - the priority construction of an economic basis, the implementation of economic reforms. The economy should develop only its inherent domestic laws without ideological pressure.
- Overcoming ideological dogmas will lead to the formation of favorable public opinion in relation to various forms of management, the perception of market technology.



Market Infrastructure

- One of the most important directions of economic reforms is to create a market infrastructure.
- Market Infrastructure is a complex of institutions, organizations, and enterprises that promote market relations and their effective functioning.
- The stock market has a special place in forming market relations.
- 'Republican Real Estate Exchange', 'Commodity Exchange', and 'Tashkent Stock Exchange'
- The banking and financial system serving the economy of the country
 - In the first year of independence only 6 banks
 - in 2002 - 40
 - however, nowadays there are 28 banks in Uzbekistan.



Privatization

- At the first stage, prices were liberalized. This process has passed without social shocks.
- The government has created various compensation funds, introduced pension benefits, and wages, pensions, and scholarships have been constantly increased.
- The market economy is primarily based on different forms of ownership, multi-disciplinary economy. In this regard, the first step in the economic reform in Uzbekistan was the denationalization and privatization of property and the formation of the proprietary class.
- Privatization began with the denationalization of trade, services and local industries, housing stock, farms producing agricultural products. It was called small privatization.
- In 1995, there was a period of mass privatization in the national economy. Now large enterprises have also been privatized. In the same year, 89 enterprises of the machine-building complex, 81 units of fuel and energy, 55 units of construction industry, 114 transports, 68 housing and communal services were privatized.



The state is the initiator and main reformer of economic transformations



- A modern socially-oriented market is regulated by the state. In the period of the formation of market relations, the state is obliged to be an active participant in the reform process, to act as its initiator as a firm, consistent guide.
- The creation of a legislative field for a socially-oriented market economy is also a characteristic feature of the formation of a rule-of-law state.
- Therefore, one of the leading principles of transition to market relations is law-abiding.



Legal Base of Economic Transformations

- Price liberalization is directly related to the creation of a competitive environment in the economy.
- Laws 'On privatization of the property' that adopted on November 18, 1991, 'On privatization of the state housing fund' (May 7, 1993) and more than 20 special government programs.
- In August 1992 the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On restriction of monopolistic activities"
- The Main Department for Antimonopoly and Pricing Policy was established in the Ministry of Finance.
- The Decrees of the President "On Measures for Further Deepening Economic Reforms" (adopted on January 21, 1994) and "Priorities for further development of the process of denationalization and privatization" (adopted on March 16, 1994).



The Third Principle

- The supremacy of law is the fundamental principle of the law-based state. It presupposes the establishment of undivided dominance in all spheres of the life of the law.
- No state body, no economic and socio-political organization, no official, no one has the right to be exempted from the duty to obey the law. A characteristic feature of the rule of law state is the existence of a high level of legal culture.
- During the first period of reforms in legislation, the Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan was adopted.
- The unicameral parliament of the period (1995-2004) was not a professional one (as a rule parliament convened four times a year) It were adopted 240 laws, introduced 1573 amendments.
- The third stage of reforms dealt with the transition from the unicameral to the bicameral parliament. A joint activity of the Legislative Chamber and the Senate of the *Oliy Majlis* in 2005-2007 resulted in the adoption of 96 laws.



Strong social policy is a reliable guarantee of economic transformation

- Protection of socially vulnerable segments of the population has been the most priority task, the leading principle of practical action.
- The main directions of social policy at the new stage of the formation of market reforms are the following:
 - 1) ensuring the rights and freedoms of citizens guaranteed by the Constitution;
 - 2) support for the most vulnerable segments of the population, but there must also be a targeted focus;
 - 3) creation of conditions for the full realization of labor potential;
 - 4) the formation of a real labor market.



Strong social policy

- The real purpose of all reforms that has implemented in the country is to create decent living conditions for the citizens. Moreover, the ignorance of people's social problems is a threat to stability and national security.
- First, measures have been taken to preserve the level of income of the
- A unified tariff scale was introduced in January 1993. This measure has allowed directly linking employees' salaries through tariff rates, to the minimum wage. By raising the minimum wage, the average wage and money incomes have also increased.
- The living standards of the population depend on:
 - the domestic consumer market
 - the prices for food
 - the prices for household goods.
- The government has set the boundaries of prices for food and industrial goods. In 1993, the list of goods and services sold at fixed and regulated prices was significantly reduced. State regulation of import wholesale prices is suspended.
- In October-November 1994, prices for basic types of consumer goods were issued, tariffs for transport and utilities services were raised.



The Fifth Principle

- To pass to the market it is not enough to adopt laws, to proclaim the equality of all forms of property.
- We need real mechanisms to ensure their implementation. These mechanisms are not included immediately.
- The transition from one socio-economic formation to another can not take place by pseudo-revolutionary leaps.
- The actual economic situation in Uzbekistan, the low living standards of the vast majority of the population, make the path of "shock therapy" unacceptable for the republic in the transition to the market.

Thank you for your attention!